

ENG504 SHORT HANDOUTS

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Lesson 11 to 15

(ENG504) Second Language Acquisition

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

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Lesson-11

UNIVERSAL GRAMMAR AND SECOND LANGUAGE LEARNING

Topic No: 063-068 - UNIVERSAL GRAMMAR AND SECOND LANGUAGE LEARNING

What are the arguments of Universal Grammar (UG)?

The evidence suggests the existence of an innate language faculty triggered biologically.

List Lenneberg's criteria for biologically triggered behaviors.

The behavior emerges before it is necessary.

Its appearance is not a result of a conscious decision.

Its emergence is not triggered by external events.

Direct teaching and intensive practice have relatively little effect.

There is a regular sequence of milestones correlated with age.

There may be a critical period for acquisition.

What is the principle of structure-dependency in UG?

Language critically depends on the structural relationship between elements in a sentence.

Define Universal Grammar's role in language learning.

First language learners have an initial state of principles, and languages vary in limited ways.

According to White, what are potential sources of crosslinguistic variation?

Differences in realized functional categories.

Variation in features of a functional category.

Variation in the strength of features.

How is Universal Grammar related to second language (SL) learning?

UG is a theory that includes both first and second language learning, with similarities between them.

What complicates the second language learning process?

Cognitive maturity, prior knowledge of another language, and diverse motivations for learning a second language.

What are the two logical possibilities regarding UG's role in second language learning (SLL)?

Second languages are not constrained by UG principles.

Second languages are UG constrained, with different hypotheses regarding access.

Explain the scope and achievements of Universal Grammar (UG).

Describing and explaining human language.

Directly relevant to the study of second language (SL).

A linguistic theory, not a learning theory.

Influential in forming hypotheses about second language acquisition (SLA).

Facilitating the understanding of linguistic knowledge in SLA.

Primarily concerned with the description and explanation of the formal system underlying language.

Excludes a theory of processing or learning.

More of a property theory than a transition theory, requiring evaluation as such.

Lesson-12

EVALUATIONS OF UNIVERSAL GRAMMAR AND COGNITIVE APPROACHES

Topic No: 069-074 - Evaluations of Universal Grammar and Cognitive Approaches

Evaluation of Universal Grammar (UG):

What is the Universal Grammar (UG) view of language?

UG views language as a mental framework underlying all human languages.

What is the focus of UG in language study?

UG is concerned with the sentence and its internal structure rather than larger units of language.

How does UG approach language clinically?

UG studies languages as a mental object, in a vacuum, without considering social or psychological aspects.

What criticism does UG face regarding methodology?

UG's methodologies are criticized for not being representative of reality and lacking reliability in SL judgments.

What is the primary focus of UG theorists?

UG theorists focus on linguistic competence, not concerned with naturalistic performance.

How has recent work in UG addressed its criticism?

Recent work in UG has used a range of elicitation techniques to enhance reliability.

What does UG approach exclusively concern itself with?

UG exclusively concerns itself with documenting and explaining the nature of SL linguistic systems, ignoring social and psychological variables.

In what ways has UG been useful for linguistic analysis?

UG has facilitated well-defined and focused hypotheses and has been useful in explaining facts about SLA.

Cognitive Approaches to Second Language Learning (SLL):

What does the Cognitive Approach to SLL emphasize?

Cognitive approaches emphasize the learning component of SLL and focus on understanding how the human brain processes and learns new information.

How do Cognitive Approaches differ from UG in terms of focus?

Cognitive Approaches focus more on the learner as an individual and how they access linguistic knowledge in real-time.

What were UG theorists primarily interested in?

UG theorists were primarily interested in competence and not concerned with real-time linguistic knowledge access or learner strategies.

Two Approaches of Cognitive Theorists of SLA:

What is the primary focus of Processing Theorists?

Processing Theorists investigate how second language learners process linguistic information and how this ability develops over time.

How do Emergentist/Constructionist theorists view knowledge and processing?

Emergentist/Constructionist theorists believe in explaining the nature of knowledge and its processing through general cognitive principles.

What do Constructivists claim about language development?

Constructivists claim that language complexity emerges from associative learning processes exposed to a massive and complex environment.

How do many Constructivists believe language develops?

Many Constructivists believe that language develops as learners move from learning exemplars committed to memory to making more abstract generalizations.

Lesson-13

MODELS OF SECOND LANGUAGE LEARNING

Topic 075: Processing Approaches in Second Language Learning

What are processing approaches in second language learning?

Processing approaches investigate how the brain's processing mechanism deals with second language, including Information Processing Models and Processability Theory.

Name the two processing approaches discussed.

Information processing approach and Processability theory.

Topic 076: Information Processing Models

What does the Information Processing approach focus on in second language learning?

It investigates how different memory stores (short-term memory, long-term memory) deal with second language information and how this information is automatized and restructured.

Name the two information processing models discussed in this lesson.

McLaughlin's Information processing model and Anderson's Active Control of Thought (ACT*) model.

Topic 077: McLaughlin's Information Processing Model

How does McLaughlin's model view humans in second language learning?

Humans are viewed as autonomous and active, and the mind is considered a general-purpose, symbol processing system.

What is automatization in McLaughlin's model, and why is it important in second language learning?

Automatization is the shift from controlled toward automatic processing via practice. It is crucial in second language learning as it involves the acquisition of complex cognitive skills.

What is fossilization in McLaughlin's model, and how does it occur?

Fossilization occurs when a controlled process becomes automatic prematurely, resulting in the inability to get rid of non-native-like structures despite abundant linguistic input.

Topic 078: Anderson's Active Control of Thought (ACT) Model

How does Anderson's ACT model differ from McLaughlin's model?

Anderson's model is more wide-ranging and posits three kinds of memory: working memory, declarative long-term memory, and procedural long-term memory.

What are the three stages of skill acquisition in Anderson's model?

The cognitive stage, the associative stage, and the autonomous stage.

What happens in the cognitive stage of skill acquisition according to Anderson's model?

In the cognitive stage, a description of the procedure is learned.

Describe the autonomous stage in Anderson's model.

In the autonomous stage, the skill becomes more and more rapid and automatic.

Topic 079: Criticisms and Implications

What criticism has been raised against Anderson's ACT model?

Anderson's model has been criticized for insisting that all knowledge starts out in declarative form, which is problematic, especially in the case of first language learners.

How can Anderson's model be applied in second language learning?

Anderson's model can be applied to aspects of second language learning that require proceduralization and automatization.

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LEARNING STRATEGIES AND SECOND LANGUAGE LEARNING

Topic No: 080-085

What are the three stages of learning mentioned in the context of second language acquisition?

Cognitive Stage: Understanding the need to add "-s" to a verb after a third-person subject.

Associative Stage: Figuring out how to add "-s" contextually, associating actions with declarative knowledge.

Autonomous Stage: Actions becoming automatic, potentially losing declarative knowledge.

According to contemporary SLL theorists, how is SL grammar initially learned?

Disagreement with Anderson's implied position that SL grammar is initially learned through conscious study and explicit rule application.

Consensus that much grammar learning occurs without conscious awareness.

How do information-processing theorists respond to the unconscious nature of grammar learning?

Suggesting subdivision of 'declarative knowledge' into conscious and unconscious parts.

Some argue that information-processing models are more useful for explaining peripheral strands in SLL.

What is the distinction between learning strategies and communication strategies?

Learning strategies: Procedures to make language learning effective.

Communication strategies: Overcoming specific communicative problems.

Name and briefly describe the three categories of learning strategies.

Metacognition strategies: Selective attention, planning, monitoring, evaluation.

Cognitive strategies: Rehearsal, organization, inferencing, summarizing, deducing, imagery, transfer, elaboration.

Social or affective strategies: Cooperation, questioning for clarification, self-talk.

How do learning strategies progress through the stages of learning?

Acquired through cognitive, associative, and autonomous stages.

May be conscious in early stages and later performed without awareness.

What challenges do O'Malley and Chamot raise regarding teaching learning strategies?

Teaching strategies require considerable time and effort for effectiveness.

Long-term studies are needed to investigate the impact of strategy teaching.

Mention general benefits of applying cognitive theory to SLA.

Learning is an active and dynamic process using various information and strategic processing modes.

Language learning involves a progression from awareness to automaticity.

Learning strategies parallel cognitive processes, positively influencing learning outcomes.

What is Anderson's Active Control of Thought (ACT*) and its role in fluency development?

ACT is Anderson's model of thought control.

Towell and Hawkins reject it, using natural language processing models to explain how grammatical knowledge transforms into fluent performance.

They appeal to the Universal Grammar approach and information-processing accounts to understand efficient use of grammatical knowledge.

Lesson-15

THEORIES OF SECOND LANGUAGE PROCESSING AND CONNECTIONISM

Topic No: 086-091: Theories of Second Language Processing and Connectionism

What are the two theories discussed in this lesson related to second language processing?

Processability Theory

Perceptual Saliency Approach

Who outlined the Processability Theory, and what is its primary aim?

Outlined by Pienemann

Aims to clarify how learners acquire computational mechanisms operating on linguistic knowledge.

What is the focus of Processability Theory regarding second language acquisition?

Focuses on the acquisition of procedural skills for processing formal properties of second languages.

According to Pienemann's Teachability Hypothesis, what does the learnability or processability model predict?

Stages of acquisition cannot be skipped through formal instructions.

Instruction is beneficial if it focuses on structures from 'the next stage.'

What is the connection between Pienemann's Teachability Hypothesis and learning and teaching?

Attempts to establish a link between learning and teaching.

What does the Perceptual Saliency Approach argue regarding language learning?

Argues that perceptual saliency of linguistic information drives the learning process, not an innate language-specific module.

According to Slobin (1979), what are the operating principles guiding children in linguistic processing?

Pay attention to the end of words.

Linguistic elements encode relations between words.

Avoid exceptions.

Underlying semantic relations should be marked overtly and clearly.

Use of grammatical markers should make semantic sense.

What does Connectionism liken the brain to, and how does learning occur in this view?

Likens the brain to a computer with neural networks.

Learning occurs through associative processes rather than the construction of abstract rules.

How does Connectionism differ from other approaches in language acquisition?

It does not believe that learning rules underlies the construction of linguistic knowledge.

Learning occurs through associative processes, not rule-governed.

What is the role of computer technology in reviving Connectionism?

Advances in computer technology have given new life to the Connectionism approach.

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